BUSINESS SETUP CHECKLIST

What my tax preparer told me to set up from day one. Check each one off.

- [ ] **File direct**
  Form your LLC with the Utah Division of Corporations (corporations.utah.gov): $59 to file, $18 a year to renew. Get your EIN free at IRS.gov.

  Watch out: lookalike sites and official-looking emails charge $200–500 for the same forms, including yearly renewals.

- [ ] **Business account first**
  Every client payment lands in the business account, then you pay yourself. Never pay personal bills from it.

  Fine: paying a business expense on a personal card. Just log it.

- [ ] **Keep every receipt**
  A phone photo in a folder counts. Card statements are a weak backup in an audit.

- [ ] **Track your miles**
  Every business drive is a deduction: $0.72 a mile right now. Log the date, where, and why.

- [ ] **Set money aside**
  25–30% of every payment if it's just you. Closer to 20% with a spouse, kids, and real expenses. Put it somewhere you won't touch.

QUESTIONS TO ASK A TAX PRO

- **Should my spouse be on the LLC?** A single-member LLC pays self-employment tax on all of its profit. A non-working spouse partner can cut that in half.
- **When does an S corp make sense?** Often around $40K a year in freelance net income.
- **Do I owe quarterly taxes?** Once you're past your first year.
- **What can I deduct?** Lowering what you're taxed on is one of the most important things you can do.

WHO I USE

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